

“WHAT COULD WE DO? THERE WAS A REIGN OF TERROR.”

Nikita Krushchev, on Stalin, February 25, 1956

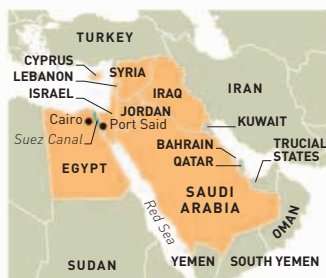
Nikita Krushchev, photographed during an eight-day visit to London. Khrushchev's "de-Stalinization" of the USSR prompted a thaw in the Cold War.



THE US CIVIL RIGHTS MOVEMENT

experienced a turbulent time this year when a black student began attending the University of Alabama. White community members attacked African-Americans, and the activities of the **Ku Klux Klan**, an organization of white supremacists, increased.

Morocco declared its independence from France on



KEY

Areas affected by the Suez Crisis

The Suez Crisis

The Suez Canal was a vital trading route from the Mediterranean to the Red Sea. It was especially important for the shipment of oil.

March 2, although Spain retained control of Ceuta and Melilla on the coast. Border disputes with Algeria led to fighting in 1963.

Riots erupted in **Cyprus** in March, after British authorities deported **Archbishop Makarios**, leader of the **campaign to unify Cyprus with Greece**. He was accused of fostering terrorism.

Egypt's **President Nasser** nationalized the **Suez Canal** on July 26. Britain and France had shares in the Suez Canal Company, and met with Israel in October to conclude a secret agreement that Israel should attack Egypt, providing a pretext for an Anglo-French invasion of the Suez Canal Zone. On October 29, **Israel invaded the Sinai Peninsula**. The US pressured Israel to withdraw, and UN forces were stationed along the Egyptian-Israeli border. The Anglo-French assault was launched on November 5. International criticism forced a ceasefire and then a withdrawal. Tensions remained high between

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Egypt and Israel following the crisis, which became known as the **Second Arab-Israeli War**.

Nikita Khrushchev, Communist Party First Secretary of the Soviet Union, **denounced Stalin** as a "brutal despot" in a speech on February 25. It outraged Stalinists, but led to the prospect of a **thaw in relations** with the US. In Eastern Europe it had a dramatic effect on raising expectations for change.

The **Hungarian Revolution**, in October, led to the formation of a liberal government and **Imre Nagy**, a moderate, became prime minister. On November 3, Nagy announced a plan to withdraw from the Warsaw Pact (see 1955). The next day, Warsaw Pact **troops invaded**, crushed the rebellion, and **reestablished control**.



The Soviets began the "Race for Space" with the launch of the world's first satellites, Sputnik I and II—an achievement celebrated by this poster.

Britain (see 1948). Eventually, Britain realized that this situation could not be resolved by military means, and made constitutional advances that culminated in the **independence of the Malayan Federation** on August 31.

President Sukarno of Indonesia had struggled to maintain a parliamentary democracy since independence in 1945. On March 14, he decided to dispense with parliament and imposed **martial law**. On December 3, Sukarno nationalized Dutch businesses; two days later he expelled all Dutch nationals.

The **Space Age** began on October 4, when Russia launched its **Sputnik I** satellite into orbit. It was followed a month later by **Sputnik 2**, which carried a dog called **Laika**.



European Economic Community

This map shows the composition of the EEC at its inception in 1957, when six countries signed the Treaty of Rome.

KASHMIR WAS FORMALLY INCORPORATED INTO INDIA

on January 26, defying a UN ruling. It was granted **special status** under India's constitution, which ensured, among other things, that non-Kashmiri Indians could not buy property there. Pakistan strongly objected (see 1917, 1965).

Ghana became the first black African country to gain its **independence** from colonial rule on March 6. The first prime minister, Dr. **Kwame Nkrumah** (1909–72), initiated ambitious development programs and spearheaded the political advancement of Africa.

The **Treaty of Rome** was signed on March 25. It set up the **EEC** (European Economic Community) and provided for the countries' social and economic programs. It also gave former colonies free trade with the EEC, and made them eligible for aid.

The suppression of communist guerillas in **Malaya** had been a constant source of concern to

